

EXT. PARK - DAY

PARK GOERS walk, lounge around, and play. A few YOUNG GIRLS jump rope.

YOUNG GIRLS

*Girls go to college to get more
knowledge; Boys go to Jupiter to get
more stupider--*

GERALD (20's), gaunt with an overall "I've given up" look, sits on a park bench next to RALPH (30's), a large sketchy-looking man with a beanie and a hoodie. High-pitched voice.

RALPH

Get more stupider? Glad that college education's paying off.

GERALD

Yea, uh. Why are we doing this here?

RALPH

It's friggin' gorgeous out here! Just wanted to, yanno. Switch up the... the
ambiance.

SHOT OF A FUNNY THING that you would see at a park. Maybe a homeless man pooping. Ralph SIGHS. Gerald raises an eyebrow.

RALPH

I gotta be real with you, Ger.

GERALD

Ger?

RALPH

I had to bamboozle ya. I didn't. I didn't want you making a scene.

GERALD

Why would I be making a scene?

Ralph takes out a piece of paper.

RALPH

(clears throat)
I miss our talks. I miss our walks. I miss ou--

GERALD

What is this? What's happening here?

Ralph puts the paper down.

RALPH
I'm interventioning. I'm. I'm
intervening on you. On your drug
problem.

GERALD
You're... You're providing me with
those drugs.

RALPH
Let's not make this about me, Ger.

Beat.

GERALD
Alright, I'm out of here.

Gerald attempts to stand, but he's handcuffed to the bench.

GERALD(CONT'D)
What the f--

Ralph holds up a key.

RALPH
Did you forget that I'm an amateur
magician in my off-hours?

GERALD
That's literally never come up in
conversation.

RALPH
I've turned a corner, Gerry. I
realized the harm I've been causing.

GERALD
That's good to hear, but--

RALPH
I'm strictly selling weed now.

GERALD
I'm happy for you, man, but I--

RALPH
And psychedelics too. Sometimes.

GERALD
Listen to me. You're wasting your
time...
(chuckling)
I don't have a problem.

RALPH
I was afraid you'd say that.

Ralph puts his phone to his ear.

RALPH(CONT'D)
Ok. Come over.

GERALD
Who was that? Who's coming over?!

RALPH
I found out where your family lives
and told them about the situation.

GERALD
You got my family involved?! Why do
you think I'm addicted to drugs in the
first place?!

RALPH
Ha! So you admit you have an
addiction! One step closer, buddy.

GERALD
You have to get me out of these cuffs.
You have no ide--

BETTY(O.S)
Ya fuckin' kiddin me, Gerald?!

BETTY, Gerald's Mom, walks over with HANK, Gerald's Brother.
Hank pushes Gerald's grandmother, LOLA, in her wheelchair.

GERALD
(sighs)
Son of a bitch.

BETTY
Ya doin drugs now?!

RALPH
Thank you for coming, Mrs. Galamad--

BETTY
And I have to find out from this
shmuck?

RALPH
... Alright.

GERALD
I don't know what this guy told you,
Ma, but I'm perfectly fine.

RALPH
--This guy--

BETTY
You look like human garbage.
(to Hank)
Tell him, Hank.

HANK
Yea, human garbage.

BETTY
Look at ya grandmotha. Fuckin'
distraught.

SHOT OF: Lola looks old and decrepit.

LOLA
EHHHHHHGGGGG

RALPH
Oh my god--

HANK
Beside herself.

BETTY
What do you have to say for yaself,
huh?

HANK
Yea, what do you have to say?

BETTY
Huh?

HANK
Huh?!

GERALD
ALRIGHT!!

Everyone's silent.

GERALD(CONT'D)
I will check into a rehab and get
myself straightened out, ok?! Are ya
happy!?

Beat.

BETTY
(endearing)
That's all we ask, sweetie.

HANK
Yea, that's all we ask.

SHOT OF: Lola, looking decrepit.

GERALD
Ralph.

RALPH
Yea?

GERALD
Please uncuff me.

RALPH
Oh, yea. My bad.

Ralph fiddles with the keys. It takes a moment.

RALPH(CONT'D)
(chuckles)
These things. They can be pretty
tricky.

Ralph uncuffs Gerald.

RALPH(CONT'D)
There we go. Ya free! heh.

Gerald and his family leave.

RALPH(CONT'D)
I'm happy for you, Gerry! Florida

livin's the best! I got a cousin out
there! Stone crabs for days!

Ralph sits there, alone.

RALPH(CONT'D)
(satisfied sigh)
Ya done the right thing, Ralphie boy.
You lost a customer but gained a
friendship...

Beat. Ralph looks over.

RALPH(CONT'D)
Hey. You, uh. You kids ever try pot?